



500 Million strong

At the current rate of growth, by either this December or January of next year, India will have its 500 millionth mobile subscriber



AVG 9 out

Developers of the world's most popular free anti-virus software, recently announced that its family of free and paid internet security products, AVG 9.0, is out

Lenovo, Sony, Toshiba and Wipro – as well as channel partners for assembled PCs. The upgrade to Windows 7 is globally available from June 26, 2009 through January 31, 2010.

Also, contrary to reports of the Windows 7 launch being delayed in India, Mr. G. Ramesh (Director Windows Client Business Group, Microsoft India) told ThinkDigit that all its OEMs have started shipping new machines on Windows 7.

Now realtime search

We all want information five seconds before it's even created, and today, Google and Bing have both accelerated towards that goal.

Both Microsoft and Google, announced within hours of each other (Microsoft going first), their plans to incorporate Twitter in their search results. Bing had earlier added limited support for searching Twitter updates by including tweets of famous celebrities in their results.

To many, who still take Twitter's "What are you doing?" rather too literally, it may seem like a waste of time, however what lies in its timeline is a history of events, changing thoughts, memes and moods: information some may find more relevant than the average search.

The real-time nature of Twitter and Facebook is of immense value, for anything between getting the latest updates during events, helpful messages during disasters, or just getting rescued from a drain. It is just one of those things we didn't know we needed, till we did, and now any search result is out of date if it doesn't take into account what people are discussing at the moment.

Google's suspiciously short announcement stating their intention to include Twitter data seems to be more of a reaction to Microsoft's announcement of the same, than a premeditated disclosure. This is what competition is all about, and it's good, the race between Google and Bing can only benefit us.

While Google plans to



To know about Google's foray into music: <http://www.thinkdigit.com/d/gmusic/>

integrate this data into its search over the "coming months", Bing's Twitter search is available right now at <http://www.bing.com/twitter> but is apparently still too good for India. No worries, just change your location using the link next to "Preferences" in the top-right corner and select "United States - English" (this will take you back to normal Bing search, however your next visit to <http://www.bing.com/twitter> will allow you to start searching)

An Apple a day

Recently, as part of a major overhaul of its computer products line-up, Apple introduced the world's first touch-sensitive mouse, called the 'Magic Mouse'. Putting an end to the previous Mighty Mouse, the Magic Mouse is a wireless mouse with no mechanical buttons, no scroll wheels and no scroll balls: it works purely on multi-touch interaction.

Users can scroll in any direction using multiple fingers, as well as use familiar finger-swipes.

Clicking the left and right buttons apparently offers physical feedback, depressing the entire white polycarbonate surface of the mouse. Those lucky few who got to experience the device say that the mouse moves a little when scrolling via touch.

We're sure glad that the mouse has the ever elusive 'right-click' that Mac were for

long averse to. Still, you need to "enable Secondary Click in System Preferences."

The Bluetooth mouse is powered by a set of AA batteries, which will last it for four months of battery life, according to Apple. The Magic Mouse will come packaged with the new



iMacs, or can be purchased independently for \$69 (Rs. 3,200 approx).

Apple also announced a new MacBook, two new iMacs and upgraded the current Mac Mini. The new MacBook is what interests us the most.

Apple renovated its lowest-end 'plastic' MacBook with a new unibody design that includes the new built-in battery offering up to seven hours of battery life – all for \$999 (Rs. 46,400 approx). Yes that's right they actually say seven hours!

The durable polycarbonate material uses the same techniques as the higher-end aluminium MacBook Pros. Along with a glass multi-touch trackpad, the device features a 13-inch LED-backlit display, 2.2GHz Intel Core2Duo processor, 2GB RAM, Nvidia GeForce 9400GM onboard graphics, 250GB hard drive and 8x SuperDrive.

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Gestures from From left to right: Single Click, Two button click, 360 scroll, zoom, two finger swipe.

International shopping made easy

Who doesn't love some good old retail therapy once in a while? But when it comes to online shopping, our choice is largely limited to stuff available within the geographical boundaries of the country. You will surely relate to the stressful times of trying to get your friends or relatives to carry stuff along for you. Although, one can order items from abroad, the process is very complicated and has still not reached the mainstream consumer. There's duties, foreign exchange, shipping and a whole lot of other things to figure out. Whatever happened to Globalisation and 'the world is flat', we wonder.

Well, it looks like eBay India is out to change things with the launch of its latest initiative - Global EasyBuy (ebay.in/geb). The promising venture might soon become the international online shopping destination for Indians, by offering shoppers convenient access to around 18 million international products. The products available are those that comply with the country's importing regulations and categories include luxury brands, electronics, books, hardware, musical instruments etc. Well international here is a misnomer. The website currently has products mostly from the US, but who's complaining. The way it works is that the consumer gets to pay a single amount (inclusive of product cost, shipping and any applicable duties) in rupees. In turn the original shipper from the US ships the product to a central hub in his country from then on eBay takes over to bring the item to your doorstep. The process takes place through eBay's secure payment gateway called PaisaPay. Head over to www.ebay.in/geb to experience it first hand and quench the shopaholic in you. The site looks fine, though be very careful with cached memory. At times with 'products last looked at' it may just take you to ebay.com which is not where you want to be. **d**